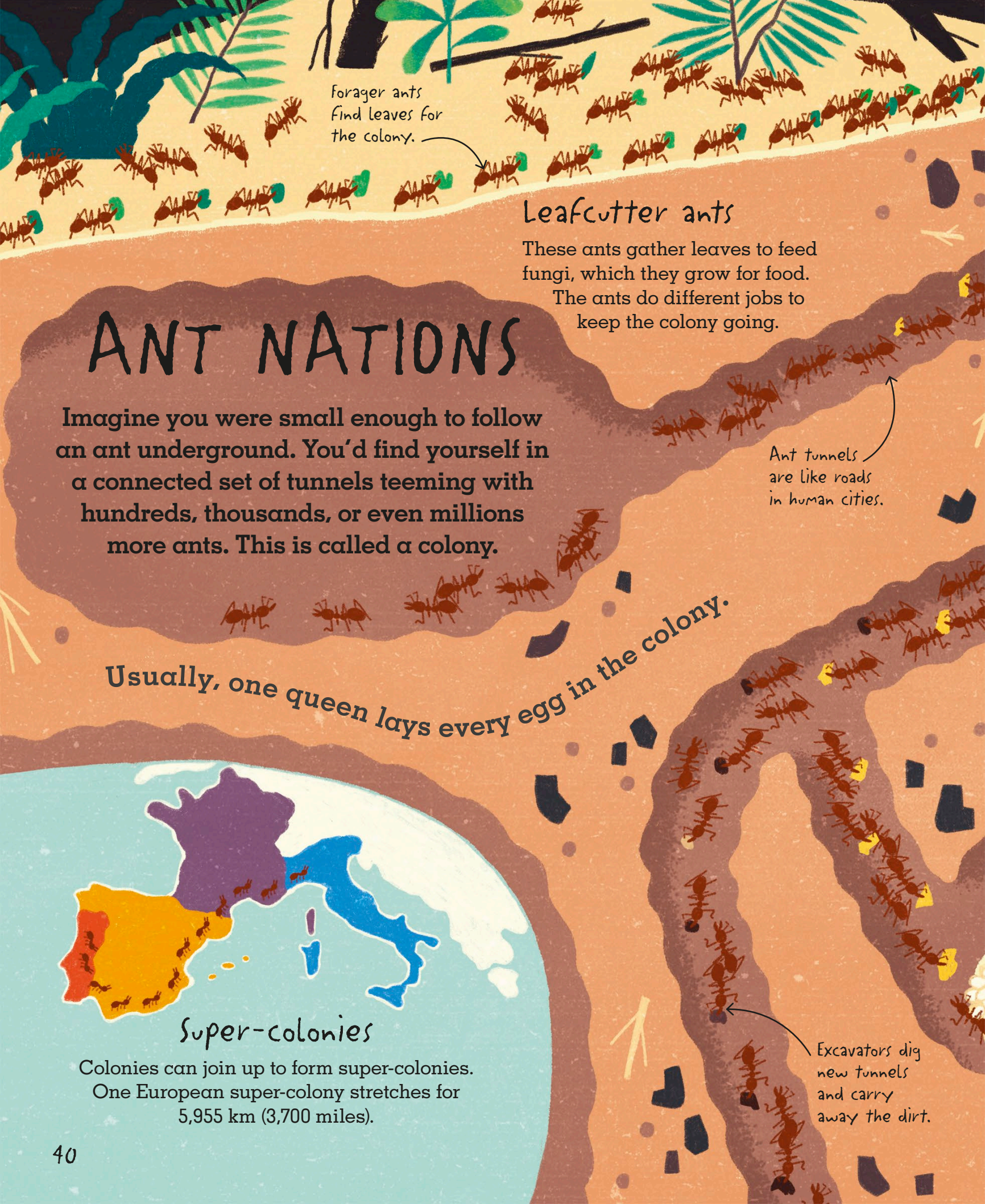




Forager ants
find leaves for
the colony.

Leafcutter ants

These ants gather leaves to feed fungi, which they grow for food.

The ants do different jobs to keep the colony going.

ANT NATIONS

Imagine you were small enough to follow an ant underground. You'd find yourself in a connected set of tunnels teeming with hundreds, thousands, or even millions more ants. This is called a colony.

Ant tunnels
are like roads
in human cities.

Usually, one queen lays every egg in the colony.



Super-colonies

Colonies can join up to form super-colonies.
One European super-colony stretches for
5,955 km (3,700 miles).

Excavators dig
new tunnels
and carry
away the dirt.